



Coco the Capybara

An amigurumi crochet pattern

US terms

Intermediate

2.5 - 3 hours

10.3 cm / 4 in tall

A low, round, bottom-heavy capybara with a blunt sewn-on muzzle, plump legs and a calm embroidered sleeping face - no plastic eyes, no small plastic parts.

36

stitches around
body and head

20

body rounds, all
count-checked

4

legs joined in,
nothing to sew

0

plastic parts -
embroidered face

Welcome

A low, round, bottom-heavy capybara with a blunt sewn-on muzzle, plump stuffed legs and a calm embroidered sleeping face. The legs are crocheted straight into the body as you go, so Coco stands on her feet, not her belly.

10.3 cm

TALL, STANDING

5 cm

WIDE AT THE BODY

36 sts

AROUND THE BODY

17 mm

FEET BELOW THE BODY

In this booklet

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Back legs stop at R8, front legs work R9 - all four feet then reach the table.

1 · Materials

Main yarn	Worsted weight (#4), warm brown, about 30 g. A smooth matte yarn shows the stitch texture best.
Face yarn	Worsted weight (#4), dark brown, about 5 g - for the closed eyes, nose and mouth. Use the same weight as the main yarn.
Hook	3.0 mm (US C-2 or D-3). The gauge is written for this hook.
Eyes	None. The sleeping face is embroidered.
Also needed	Polyester fibre filling about 5-8 g; yarn needle; stitch marker; pins. Pins matter: the muzzle and ears are pinned before sewing.



Body and head are both 36 stitches around; the R10 waist is deliberately shallow.

GAUGE & SIZE

36 sc around measures about 52 mm in diameter when stuffed (4.5 mm per stitch, 4.3 mm per round). Check it on the body after R6 - a stuffed tube, not a flat swatch. If your 36 stitches measure wider than 52 mm, crochet more tightly or go down a hook size; a loose gauge will show stuffing.

How the size adds up

Legs below the body	4 rounds x 4.3 mm	17 mm
Body + head, R1 - R20	20 rounds x 4.3 mm	86 mm
Total standing height	17 + 86	103 mm (10.3 cm)

Abbreviations (US terms)

MR magic ring	sc single crochet
inc increase (2 sc in one st)	invdec invisible decrease
sc* sc worked through leg AND body together	st(s) stitch(es)
FO fasten off	(n) stitch count at round end

2 · Techniques

Everything this pattern uses, in the order you will meet it.

1

The magic ring

Every piece begins with a magic ring. Pull the tail tight once the first round is complete.

2

Working in a spiral

Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and move it up. There is no seam and no join to count from. Do not chain 1 between rounds.

3

The two-layer leg join

The only fiddly step - worth practising once on a scrap magic ring. Hold a finished leg against the body with the pinched-flat top of the leg lying against the outside of the body. Insert the hook through BOTH the leg and the body stitch and work one single crochet; leg edge and body stitch are treated as one stitch. Every count in the body table stays correct. Pinch the leg top flat first - a round, un-pinched top will not lie against the curved body and the join will pucker.

4

Pinching the leg top

A 9-stitch leg top flattens to about 5 stitches across - pinch it down to a strip about 3 stitches wide and hold it while you join. The stitches you don't join bunch up inside, and that bunch makes the leg look plump rather than tubular.

3 · Legs - make 4

Stuff the lower half of each leg lightly, leaving the top loose. Back legs stop after Rnd 8; front legs work Rnd 9 too - they join one round higher and need to be one round longer so all four feet reach the table level.

Leg · make 4

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	all four
R2	[1 sc, inc] x 3	(9)	all four
R3	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R4	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R5	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R6	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R7	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R8	sc in each st around	(9)	BACK legs finish here
R9	sc in each st around	(9)	FRONT legs only



Back legs stop at R8, front legs work R9 - all four feet then reach the table.

FO with a long tail. Before joining, pinch the whole 9-stitch top flat into a narrow strip about 3 stitches wide (technique 3).

4 · Ears & muzzle

Ears are shallow cups and are not stuffed. The muzzle is stuffed just enough to hold a dome; it should sit proud of the head when sewn on.

Ear · make 2 · do not stuff

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	[1 sc, inc] x 3	(9)	
R3	sc in each st around	(9)	

FO with a long tail; do not stuff - a shallow cup.

Muzzle · make 1 · stuff lightly

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	[1 sc, inc] x 3	(9)	
R3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	(12)	
R4	sc in each st around	(12)	
R5	sc in each st around	(12)	

FO with a long tail and stuff lightly, just enough to hold a dome.

5 · Body & head – one piece

Both are 36 stitches around with only a shallow waist between them - that is what makes Coco read as one round blob rather than a snowman. The legs are joined low at R4-R5 as you work those rounds: every stitch marked *sc** is worked through a pinched leg top AND the body stitch together (technique 3). Those stitches still count, so the totals do not change.

Body & head · R1 - R20

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	
R3	[1 sc, inc] x 6	(18)	
R4	3 <i>sc*</i> , 1 sc, inc , 3 <i>sc*</i> , [1 sc, inc] x 5	(24)	join the BACK legs
R5	[2 sc, inc] x 4, 3 <i>sc*</i> , 1 sc, inc , 1 sc, 3 <i>sc*</i> , 1 sc, inc , 1 sc	(30)	join the FRONT legs
R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	full width - check gauge
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	
R9	sc in each st around	(36)	stuff the body FIRMLY
R10	[7 sc, invdec] x 4	(32)	shallow waist
R11	[7 sc, inc] x 4	(36)	head begins
R12	sc in each st around	(36)	muzzle over R12 - R14
R13	sc in each st around	(36)	
R14	sc in each st around	(36)	eyes at R14 - R15
R15	sc in each st around	(36)	ears at R15
R16	[4 sc, invdec] x 6	(30)	
R17	[3 sc, invdec] x 6	(24)	stuff the head firmly
R18	[2 sc, invdec] x 6	(18)	
R19	[1 sc, invdec] x 6	(12)	top up stuffing
R20	invdec x 6	(6)	



Body and head are both 36 stitches around; the R10 waist is deliberately shallow.

Cinch the remaining 6 stitches closed and weave the tail inside the body. Do not decrease the R10 waist further - a narrow neck cannot hold the head upright on this shape.

- Joining the legs in R4 and R5: R4, BACK legs (24). Work the first 3 sc through a pinched leg and the body together, 1 sc, inc, then the next 3 sc through the second leg and the body together, then [1 sc, inc] x 5 to the end. The two back legs sit a quarter-turn apart.
- R5, FRONT legs (30). [2 sc, inc] x 4, then 3 sc through a leg, 1 sc, inc, 1 sc, 3 sc through the other leg, 1 sc, inc, 1 sc. This puts the front pair directly opposite the back pair, each pair about a quarter-turn wide - a roughly square footprint of about 30 mm a side.

- Hold the piece upside down and check all four legs sit square before you stuff the body. The side with the front legs is the front of the toy - centre the muzzle and eyes over it.

6 · Assembly & finishing

BEFORE YOU SEW - LAY EVERY COMPONENT OUT AND CHECK

4 legs (2 back of 8 rounds, 2 front of 9) · 2 ears · 1 muzzle · 1 body & head, closed at the crown

Muzzle

Stuff lightly and pin it to the front of the head over R12-R14, centred, then sew all the way around with matching brown. It should sit proud of the head, not flush. Centring matters - the eyes go 6 stitches apart and a muzzle pinned even slightly off-centre crowds one eye.

Eyes

Embroider. With dark brown, work a shallow downward arc about 3 stitches wide on each side, at R14-R15, 6 stitches apart, with a tiny tick angled down at each outer end. This closed-eye curve is what makes Coco look asleep.

Nose & mouth

Embroider AFTER the muzzle is sewn on, so the stitches sit on the finished curve. On the muzzle, work a small dark triangle at top centre, a short vertical line down from it, and a soft curved mouth to one side.

Ears

Pinch the base of each ear so it cups forward, then sew at R15, about 5 stitches apart, angled slightly outward. R15 is a full 36-stitch round, so this puts the ears on top of the head where a capybara's belong.

Legs

The legs were joined during R4-R5 - there is nothing to sew. Just check each pinched 3-stitch strip is caught fully in the round.

Final shaping

Roll the finished piece gently between your palms to settle the stuffing into a round, bottom-heavy shape.



7 · Troubleshooting

Coco looks too tall. Almost always too many plain rounds. R12-R15 is the straight head section the face is positioned on; adding 'just one more' round turns the shape into a tower and moves the face.

Coco will not stand. Check the join height, not the leg spacing. The legs belong on R4 and R5; joined any higher, they cannot clear the underside of the body and the belly rests on the table.

Coco tips forward or backward. The two pairs must sit opposite each other: back legs on the R4 stitches given, front legs on the R5 stitches given. Turn the piece upside down before stuffing and check the four feet make a square. If still tipping, stuff the lower body more firmly.

Rocks back, front feet in the air. All four legs are the same length and they cannot be. Front legs join at R5 (21 mm up), back at R4 (17 mm up); work the front legs 9 rounds and the back legs 8.

The head flops back. The R10 waist is deliberately shallow at 32 stitches - do not decrease it further. A narrow neck cannot hold the head upright.

Small hole where a leg meets the body. You joined a flat, wide leg top instead of a pinched one. Flatten the whole 9-stitch top into a strip about 3 stitches wide before joining, so the un-joined stitches bunch up inside.

Muzzle looks flat, or stuffing shows. Stuff the muzzle just enough to hold a dome. If stuffing shows through the body, your gauge is too loose - 36 stitches should measure 52 mm; crochet tighter or go down a hook size.

Colourways



Left to right: classic warm brown, soft grey, sandy beige, cocoa. Swap the main yarn - the sleeping face stays dark brown or charcoal.

8 · Terms of use

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